

Meghna Gupta

Ph.D. Candidate in Human Centered Design and Engineering

Research Interests: Human-centered AI, AI Companions, AI Safety, Digital Safety and Privacy, Children and Families, Care, Family-centered Technologies

Department of Human Centered Design and Engineering
University of Washington, Seattle, WA, USA

Email: megupta@uw.edu

Website: <https://gupta-meghna64.github.io/>

Education

- 2023 - Present **University of Washington**, Seattle, WA
Ph.D. in Human Centered Design and Engineering
Advisor: Prof. Julie Kientz
- 2023 - 2025 **University of Washington**, Seattle, WA
M.S. in Human Centered Design and Engineering (GPA: 3.95)
- 2016 - 2020 **Indraprastha Institute of Information Technology**, Delhi
B.Tech. (Hons) in Computer Science and Engineering (CSE)
Advisors: Prof. Grace Eden and Prof. Pushendra Singh

Publications

CONFERENCE AND JOURNAL PAPERS

- 2026 **Meghna Gupta**, Sophie Stephenson, Apu Kapadia, Julie Kientz, and Franziska Roesner. "[They are not my children to post](#)": Examining Non-Parental Sharenting Practices in In-home Child-care. *Upcoming at Symposium on Usable Privacy and Security (SOUPS'26)*
- 2026 **Meghna Gupta**, Mitsuka Kiyohara, Ranjitha Naruganahalli Rangaswamy, Franziska Roesner, and Julie Kientz. [Exploring AI Companions Together: A Structured Family Co-Investigation of Character.AI](#). In *ACM Conference on Interaction Design and Children (IDC'26)*
- 2026 Aayushi Dangol*, **Meghna Gupta***, Daeun Yoo, Robert Wolfe, Jason Yip, Franziska Roesner, and Julie Kientz. [Toys that listen, talk, and play: Understanding Children's Sensemaking and Interactions with AI Toys](#). In *ACM Conference on Interaction Design and Children (IDC'26)* (* = Equal Contribution)

2026

- Meghna Gupta**, George Zhang, Sophie Stephenson, Franziska Roesner, and Julie Kientz. [Consent under Constraints : Negotiating Photography and Media Sharing in Institutionalized Child-care](#). In *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI'26)*
- 2025 **Meghna Gupta**, Arpita Bhattacharya, and Julie Kientz. ["Being a nanny isn't just caregiving": An Analysis of How Nannies Seek Support in Online Communities like /r/Nanny](#). In *The Symposium on Human-Computer Interaction for Work (CHIWORK'25)*.
- 2025 **Meghna Gupta** and Audrey Desjardins. [Echoes of Care: Unveiling the Intertwined Tensions between Childcare Work and Voice Assistants](#). In *ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI'25)*.
- 2024 Peya Mowar, **Meghna Gupta**, and Mohit Jain. 2024. [Breaking the News Barrier: Towards Understanding News Consumption Practices among BVI Individuals in India](#) . In *ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '24)*.
- 2024 Caitlin Lustig, Maya Kaneko*, **Meghna Gupta***, Kavita Dattani*, Audrey Desjardins, and Daniela Rosner. [Porous by Design: How Childcare Platforms Impact Worker Personhood, Safety, and Connection](#). In *ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS'24)*. [Best Paper Award] (* = Equal Contribution)
- 2024 Pradyumna YM, Vinod Ganesan, Dinesh Kumar Arumugam, **Meghna Gupta**, Nischith Shadagopan, Tanay Dixit, Sameer Segal, Pratyush Kumar, Mohit Jain, Sriram Rajamani. [PwR: Exploring the Role of Representations in Conversational Programming](#). ([arXiv](#))
- 2024 **Meghna Gupta***, Nimisha Karnatak*, Mohit Jain. [Understanding the Technology-Mediated Home Phlebotomy Ecosystem in India](#). *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 8, CSCW1, Article 144. (CSCW'24) (* = Equal Contribution)
- 2023 Anant Mittal, **Meghna Gupta**, Roshni Poddar, Tarini Naik, Seethalakshmi Kuppuraj, James Fogarty, Pratyush Kumar, and Mohit Jain. 2023. [Jod: Examining Design and Implementation of a Videoconferencing Platform for Mixed Hearing Groups](#). In *ACM SIGACCESS Conference on Computers and Accessibility (ASSETS '23)*.
- 2023 Harsh Vijay, Saumay Pushp, Amish Mittal, Praveen Gupta, **Meghna Gupta**, Sirish Gambhira, Shivang Chopra, Mayank Baranwal, Arshia Arya, Ajay Manchepalli, and Venkata N. Padmanabhan. 2023. [HyWay: Enabling Mingling in the Hybrid World](#). In *ACM Interact. Mob. Wearable Ubiquitous Technology (IMWUT '23)*.
- 2022 Azra Ismail, Deepika Yadav, **Meghna Gupta**, Kirti Dabas, Pushpendra Singh, and Neha Kumar. [Imagining Caring Futures for Frontline Health Work](#). *Proc. ACM Hum.-Comput. Interact.* 6, CSCW2, Article 480 (November 2022), 30 pages. (CSCW '22).
- 2022

Meghna Gupta, Devansh Mehta, Anandita Punj, and Indrani Medhi Thies. 2022. [Sophistication with Limitation: Understanding Smartphone Usage by Emergent Users in India](#). In *ACM SIGCAS/SIGCHI Conference on Computing and Sustainable Societies (COMPASS '22)*.

2022 **Meghna Gupta** and Grace Eden. 2022. [The Human-Air Interface: Responding To Poor Air Quality Through Lived Experience and Digital Information](#). In *ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '22)*.

ABSTRACTS AND POSTERS

2024 Tanvi Roy and **Meghna Gupta**. 2024. [Weaponizing Cringe for Virality: Paving the Way for Democratization on Social Media](#). In Proceedings of the Social Media and Society in India Conference held at the University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, April 9-10, 2024 (**SMSI '24**).

2022 Jasmeet Kaur, **Meghna Gupta**, and Pushpendra Singh. 2022. [Understanding the Role of Technology-mediated Solutions for Women's Safety in Urban India](#). In *ACM SIGCAS/SIGCHI Conference on Computing and Sustainable Societies (COMPASS '22)*.

2020 Arpit Bhatia, **Meghna Gupta**, Abhishek Gupta, and Nishtha Singhal. 2020. [AICA: Artificial Intelligence Conversation Assistant](#). In *ACM Designing Interactive Systems Conference (DIS '20 Companion)*.

WORKSHOP PAPERS

2026 **Meghna Gupta**. [Boundary Collapse: Looking beyond Content-based Harms in AI Companion Interactions](#). In *Social and Emotional Uses of AI: Bridging Mental Health, Responsible AI, and Digital Safety Workshop and Developmentally Safe Generative AI Environments for Youth Workshop* at **CHI '26**.

2022 **Meghna Gupta**. [Seeking Digital Care in Low-Resourced Contexts: Identifying Opportunities and Challenges](#). In *Information-Seeking Online Workshop* at (**CSCW '22**).

2020 **Meghna Gupta** and Grace Eden. [Meaning in Language: From Professional to Local Contexts](#). In *(Coping With) Messiness in Ethnography Workshop* at (**ECSCW '20**).

Professional Experience

2021 - 2023 **Research Fellow**, Microsoft Research India
Advisors: Dr. Indrani Medhi Thies, Dr. Mobit Jain
Worked on several research projects around Human Computer Interaction (HCI) and Information Communication and Technologies for Development (ICTD), specifically in the context of emerging digital technologies, healthcare and well-being, and accessibility.

- 2021 - 2021 **Research Intern**, Microsoft Research India
Advisor: Dr. Indrani Medhi Thies
 Worked on understanding smartphone usage among emergent users in low-income communities in India across both urban and rural areas.
- 2020 - 2022 **Research Assistant**, Intelligent and Interactive Systems Lab, IIIT Delhi
Advisors: Dr. Pushpendra Singh, Prof. Neha Kumar
 Worked on research problems around gender, health and well-being, and labor in India, with specific focus on (1) women safety in public spaces, and (2) care routines of frontline health workers (FHWs) during COVID-19.
- 2020 - 2021 **Software Engineer**, NatWest (Royal Bank of Scotland)
 Worked on enhancing the user experience of a CI/CD dashboard (Hygieia) by customizing the widgets corresponding to various stages of integration and deployment pipeline in the Software Development Cycle (SDC).

Grants & Funding

- 2026 **Open AI and Mental Health Grant Award**
 Awarded \$25k funding to support our work on Children and Emotionally Responsive AI Systems [\[link\]](#) (*declined*).
- 2026 **HCDE Doctoral Student Research Grant**
 Awarded \$600 funding to support our work on Investigating Emerging AI Companions in Children's Play Environments (w/ Aayushi Dangol).
- 2025 **Google Academic Research Award**
 Awarded \$100k funding to support our work on Designing Family-Centered Safety Tools for Teen-AI Companion Interactions (w/ Profs. Julie Kientz and Franziska Roesner) [\[link\]](#).
- 2023 **UW GSEE Icon Scholarship**
 Received University of Washington GSEE Icon Scholarship (\$2500) as a top-up fellowship for the PhD program.

Academic Service

RESEARCH MENTORING

- 2025 Alissa Chun (Summer DUB REU Student, University of Washington)
- 2025 George Zhang (MS in HCDE, University of Washington)
- 2025 Mitsuka Kiyohara (Summer DUB REU Student, University of Washington)

TEACHING

- 2025 Directed Research Group Lead, University of Washington
Course: HCDE 496/596: Exploring Photography and Social Media Guidelines in Childcare Institutions

REVIEWER

- 2025 - Present HCDE PhD Applications Reviewer
2025 - Present HCDE MS Applications Reviewer
2025 - Present ACM Conference on Designing Interactive Systems (DIS)
2024 - Present International Conference on Social Media and Society in India (SMSI)
2023 - Present ACM SIGCAS/SIGCHI Conference on Computing and Sustainable Societies (COMPASS)
2022 - Present ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW)
2021 - Present ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI)
2021 - Present ACM CHI Late Breaking Work (LBW)

STUDENT VOLUNTEER

- 2024 ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work and Social Computing (CSCW)
2022 ACM SIGCHI Symposium for HCI and Friends
2022 ACM Designing Interactive Systems (DIS)

INVITED TALKS

- 2022 What does working in HCI for Global Development look like? | Introduction to HCI, IIIT Delhi
2022 Technology and Global Development at CHI 2021 | TEM Group at MSR India
2021 Intersectionality: An Ongoing Discussion | TEM Group at MSR India

Awards & Honors

- 2026 **University of Washington Nominee, Google PhD Fellowship 2026**
Selected by the University of Washington through a competitive university-wide nomination process.
- 2026 **Human Computer Interaction Consortium 2026**
Selected as one of the two sponsored students from UW to participate in Human Computer Interaction Consortium, June 2026 in Colorado, USA.
- 2026 **Common Sense Summit on Kids and Families 2026**
Received Scholarship (\$1500) to attend 2026 Common Sense Summit on Kids and Families, March 2026 in San Francisco, USA.
- 2024

CRA-WP: Grad Cohort Workshop for Women

Received Scholarship to attend Grad Cohort Workshop, April 2024 in Minneapolis, USA.

2020 **Undergraduate Thesis**

Received Dean's letter of appreciation and recognition for significant achievements in undergraduate thesis.

2017 **Google Women Techmakers Travel Grant**

Youngest of the 10 women across the world to be awarded travel support to attend the Firebase Dev Summit 2017 in Amsterdam.

2014 **National Talent Search Exam Scholarship**

Awarded by Government of India to identify and recognize students (top 0.01% students) with high intellect and academic talent at national level.

2013 **Junior Science Talent Search Exam Scholarship**

Awarded by Central Board of Secondary Education to academically bright students (top 150 students) belonging to Delhi State.

Leadership & Volunteering

2021 **TEM Reading Group, MSR India | Organizer**

Responsible for organizing a lab-wide reading group and arranging talks in HCI, ICTD, and related areas.

2017 **Government Co. Senior Secondary School | Teacher**

Responsible for teaching a class of 30+ students – covered academic curriculum as well art and craft, computer lab and fitness sessions.

Selected Software Projects

2021 - 2022 **HyWay: Enabling Unstructured Conversations in the New Hybrid World [\[link\]](#)**

Microsoft Research India, *Advisors: Dr. Venkat Padmanabham, Dr. Ajay Manchipalli*

Our team designed, developed, and deployed a hybrid communication platform to improve interactions between today's physical and virtual users with 100+ attendees. Specifically, I worked on designing a virtual map to enable fluid movement, muffled audio of users based on the distance for porous conversations.

2019 - 2019 **Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) Connect [\[link\]](#)**

IIIT Delhi, *Advisor: Prof. Ponnurangam Kumaraguru*

Developed an Android application to facilitate interactions between DMRC officials and Delhi

Metro users using human-centered design methodologies. Covered by various media houses across New Delhi.

2019 - 2019

Conference Portal: Designing conference applications in a click! [\[link\]](#)

IIIT Delhi, *Advisor: Prof. Pushpendra Singh*

Designed and developed a Django-based web platform that can be used by conferences (academic or non-academic) to automatically generate a customized android application for their conference as per their requirements. Used at ICTD 2019 to generate official conference mobile applications.

Skills

Research Methods:	Semi-structured Interviews, Surveys, Ethnographic Observations, Usability Testing and Evaluation, Technology Probes, Participatory Design, Quantitative Study
Design Tools:	Adobe XD, Proto.io, Adobe Photoshop
Programming Languages:	Python, Java, Javascript

Last updated: June 10, 2026 • <https://www.LaTeXTemplates.com>